

Yongseok Choi 최용석

Senior Backend / Platform Engineer · Kotlin / JVM — 7 yrs engineering, 9 yrs total

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I came to engineering from business operations — I ran HR at a shipping company for two years before I wrote production code, and I still design systems the way an operator would: around the handoffs, the messy parts, and the people who have to trust the output. At Baemin I own my team's infrastructure, and most recently I built and shipped the **agent pipeline that now runs our spec-to-QA process**, because everyone had adopted AI individually and no one owned whether the outputs connected. I believe the best engineering solves the problem without writing code.

EXPERIENCE

Apr 2023
— Present

Woowa Brothers — Baemin, Korea's largest food delivery platform

Backend Engineer · Team infrastructure owner

NOW Agent pipeline for the spec-to-QA process n8n + Claude · in production

- PM, engineers, and QA each used AI alone. **No one owned the seams between them.** I built the layer that does.
- Reads the PRD against the codebase → writes the tech spec, reviews the PRD, lists open questions.
- Feature push → updates the checklist, moves the Jira ticket.
- Writes QA docs scoped to the change's **real blast radius**. QA gaps route back as code-fix proposals.
- An **observer** holds context across every document and flags blockers, slippage, and missed coverage.
- Hardest part was tech specs a PM trusts and acts on — I was in HR before I was an engineer, so I know where non-engineers lose the thread.

In production use by the team · built on existing tools, no new system

Cross-domain infrastructure redesign Mar — Sep 2025

- Infra, backend, and frontend were tightly coupled — scaling and incident response both suffered.
- Redesigned from the infra layer up: service separation, deploy restructuring, legacy auth filter overhaul.
- Owned infra config through the migration. Written up on the Woowa tech blog and presented at townhall.

20% lower backend CPU/memory · 50% less auth code · ₩500K/mo saved · zero-incident migration

Approval productivity measurement & dashboard Feb — Sep 2024

- No quantitative view of approver workload — policy changes couldn't be validated with data.
- Normalized approval events into an aggregate model; built the pipeline for cycle time, throughput, and bottlenecks.
- Designed the metrics **from my own HR domain experience** — why the numbers meant anything to the business.

Featured in *Woowa Backend Engineering* (우아한 백엔드 개발) · Woowa tech blog

Salesforce external integration & hardening Apr — Aug 2023

- Team's first external SaaS integration. Hard requirement: outside failures must never reach internal approval and contract transactions.
- Event-driven async on internal CDC events — business logic fully separated from integration logic.
- Per-event state, failure-typed retry pipelines, scheduler-based reprocessing with alerting.

Zero internal downtime through external outages · became the team's standard for every integration since

Team infrastructure ownership ongoing

- Introduced OpenTelemetry logging (unified request tracing across services); migrated EC2 → Kubernetes; Kafka connector setup and stabilization; SNS/SQS hardening (SDK upgrade, security config, cross-account wiring); Spring Boot 2.7 → 3.4 with the full JVM/Kotlin/Gradle upgrade.

Aug 2022
— Apr 2023

Yanolja Tech — R&D, Dodo Point loyalty platform

Backend Part Lead

- Ran the Dodo Point rewards service at **10M+ members, 100K+ daily transactions**.
- Built the dormant-member archival, sync, and purge pipeline. Tuned Celery group parallelism; Python migration scripts with multiprocessing.
- Rewrote the bulk message targeting query (Postgres). Consent and privacy logic across store, mobile, and landing channels.

Targeting query 60s+ → under 8s · 10M archived, 10M synced, 4M purged

Nov 2021
– May 2022

DeepBrain AI — AI human / avatar platform

Full-stack Engineer

- **Shipped the AI Human all-in-one template solo** — design, DB, backend, frontend, deploy, ops. Chatbot, STT, AI and speech models all configured from admin. Released web, mobile, and tablet.
- Scaled the relay server under heavy traffic: dual redundancy, DB replica set, load balancing, master-DB caching redesign.
- Rebuilt preview rendering from video to canvas image sequencing. Added gesture support to the web SDK.
Preview render 30s → under 7s (4-5×) · 3 platforms shipped by one engineer

Aug 2019
– Nov 2021

TmaxEnterprise

Full-stack Engineer, Team Lead

- Built a customizable ERP HR system (Spring, JPA, Oracle, React) — HR, org, and evaluation modules from planning through backend.
- Dynamic-query compound assignment; slow-query remediation and index review; PL/SQL approval-line logic.
- MSA transition TF: Spring Cloud stack, event storming across HR/payroll/accounting, hexagonal skeleton.
Top performance rating for the employee-group feature

Dec 2017
– Jul 2019

KMTC — Korea Marine Transport Co.

Human Resources

- Ran HR end to end — recruiting, payroll, personnel. Introduced an IT recruiting platform; led the ERP evaluation-system improvement. *This is the operations experience my engineering still runs on.*
- Company representative in the shipping-logistics blockchain consortium led by Samsung SDS and the Korea Customs Service.
Internal idea award — shared repair-record platform for vendors, carriers, and insurers

SELECTED SIDE WORK

~2.5 years

Contract engineering — alongside full-time work

- Built an **AI pharmacy platform** and refactored a **gift commerce platform** — consumer healthcare and commerce. Both under client confidentiality; happy to talk through the architecture and tradeoffs in conversation.

7 months
pre-COVID

Airbnb — whole-unit rental, Sinchon, Seoul

Operated solo, end to end

- Listed rooms individually — barely booked. Single-room supply in the area was saturated.
- **Changed the product.** Rented the whole unit, repositioned on the one thing neighbors couldn't offer — no landlord downstairs, so parties and family gatherings were allowed — and furnished it to match.
- Two-tier pricing: ₩150K/night for week-plus stays, ₩300K/night single nights with services bundled.
- Ran 7 months until COVID and lease expiry. I cleaned it myself every day.
Superhost in 1 month · peak ₩4.5M/month on ₩150K rent (30×)

SKILLS

LANGUAGES	Kotlin, Java, Python, JavaScript
FRAMEWORKS	Spring / Spring Boot, Spring Cloud, Node.js, Flask, React, Next.js
DATA	MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
INFRA	AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, IAM), Kubernetes, Kafka, n8n
OBSERVABILITY	OpenTelemetry, Elasticsearch / Kibana / Logstash, Loki, Grafana
AI	Claude skills and agent workflows running in production

WRITING

BOOK	<i>Woowa Backend Engineering</i> (『우아한 백엔드 개발』) — approval productivity system, featured case
TECH BLOG	techblog.woowahan.com/24066 — cross-domain infrastructure redesign · /20029 — approval productivity

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

EDUCATION	Yonsei University — B.A., Economics
LANGUAGES	Korean (native) · English (fluent, TOEIC 985)